

GENDER

Bela Mehta vs. Prashant Dabholkar



BENDERS

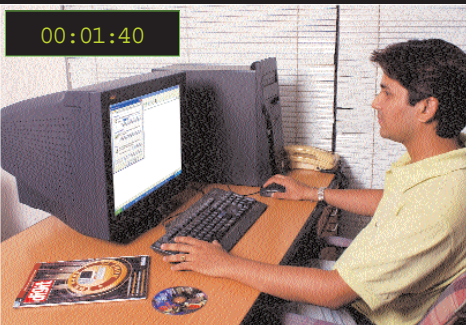
Make IE always load pages from cache

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We figured Bela knew something about how to go about the task, seeing as she was so keen to take it up: she was at it before we could say "Achtung"! Clicking open IE, she went to Tools, opened Internet Options and was at Settings. She did pause here for a while and wondered what to click on. After some tense pondering, she clicked "Every time you start IE". But when she opened IE and browsed a little, she found the setting wasn't working. Bela then retracted her choice and clicked on "Never".

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Prashant said he could do the task in two ways. He first right-clicked on the IE icon on the Quick Launch bar, and went to Properties > Shortcut. He immediately realised he'd done something wrong, but he misguidedly went on to clear the IE History. We explained the task again to a confused Prashant, and he seemed to know that the path was only through Internet Options—he was there in a jiffy. Once in Settings, he knew that clicking on Never was what needed doing.

supporters of e-mail verification, and has been accused of aggressively pushing its Sender ID product aggressively. Whether Microsoft has vested interests or not, the fact is that the world has lost faith in e-mail, and ~some~ software or authentication system is a must if we are to ever take e-mail seriously again!

Most of us worry about e-mail filters falsely identifying genuine e-mail as spam, especially since we're used to just deleting everything in our junk mail folders. Since most of us would rather let some spam through every day, than even lose one genuine e-mail by software that classifies it as spam, Microsoft has worked hard

on reducing the number of *false positives*—good e-mail identified as spam—and claims that with the enhanced anti-spam filter and Sender ID working together, they have been able to bring the false positives down to anywhere between 80 per cent and zero! It also claims that the amount of spam e-mail that's let through to the average inbox on a server running Sender ID is reduced by 85 per cent.

In the long run, Microsoft claims it will be able to eradicate phishing and e-mail spoofing, because Sender ID works by verifying that the server who sent the e-mail actually resolves as the domain it was sent from. Microsoft also wants to set up a rating system to identify domains or servers as spammers or clean mail senders, by using Sender ID and spam filters to distinguish between which servers or domains send out spam and which don't.

Another technology that promises to do away with spam and phishing is DomainKeys Identified Mail (DKIM), a cross between Yahoo!'s DomainKeys software and Cisco's Internet Identified Mail software. DKIM works by attaching a digital signature to e-mail that is encrypted using a public key encryption method so that recipients (or their e-mail software, more appropriately) can verify that the mail was indeed sent from the claimed sender.

The problem is that so many companies have been working on solutions that

we now have an embarrassment of choices, and none of them are 100 per cent fool-proof. What we really need is for all these big companies to get together and fight the spammer as one organisation instead of squabbling over whose technology is better.

WATCH THE ADS—OR ELSE!

Philips' Patent Resurrected

You've probably wondered at some point or the other: "What's the point of pop-up ads when everyone has a pop-up blocker?" The answer to that question is that *not* everyone has a pop-up blocker: yes, there still are people who use browsers that don't have them, or, such folks don't enable the blocker (unless it's enabled by default). Then there are Flash ads, and people are installing plugins such as Flashblock for Firefox. What will happen to online advertising when everyone installs a blocker for everything?

You get all this free stuff on the Net without paying a penny—isn't it fair that the ads get watched?

Now, take this to the context of TV, and it's even worse: people just change the channel when the ads begin. And you don't even have to be tech-savvy in the least to do that! So Philips is planning to patent a technique that will prevent viewers from skipping

High-Definition (HD)

HD, meaning four times current DVD quality, is all over the news: "Toshiba will begin selling laptops with HD DVD-ROM drives in Japan in mid-May." Then there's "HD Radio to See Broader Availability," in the wake of "RadioShack to Offer HD Radios." And then, "Sky's upcoming PVR will be able to record 30 hours of Hi-Def telly, courtesy a 160 GB hard drive." Then take this: "Atome Launches MPEG-4 AVC/H.264 Real-Time

HD Hardware Encoder." And this: "Sanyo launches two new HD Ready LCDs. The 27-inch and 32-inch LD6 models succeed the existing LD4 range..." Cameras aren't spared, either: "Canon Introduces HDgc High Definition Lenses to Support the Expanding HD Camera Market." DVD formats, radio, PVRs, hardware encoders, LCD screens, cameras... yes, it's an HD-mad, mad, mad, mad world! Though India isn't shining on it yet!

Buzzword
of the MONTH